

CASIO EXILIM Z750

The Casio Exilim Z750 may not be the 'newest' sensation around, but it is a sensation nonetheless. A couple of years ago, Casio launched the Exilim range, touted as the slimmest and most compact camera available. Even today, that billing stays. These stunning works of art are now adding to their capabilities and the Z750 has a whopping 7.2-megapixel CCD. Makes you wonder how they manage to keep the camera so slim...

What will further make you wonder how is when you find out that the camera also has 3x optical zoom, a 2.5-inch TFT screen and an optical viewfinder.

You'll now need to really stretch your imagination to figure out how a very slim battery in a very slim camera can capture 325 images per charge. Well, it does. So there... you don't really have to worry about how long the battery will last and whether this is just a good-looking camera.

Further proof that this beauty does indeed have brains is the fact that there are 30 preset

best shot scene modes. All you need to do is set it and shoot. But wait—there's more.

In-camera special effects allow you have some fun and not capture just photos. Speaking of not capturing just photos, did we mention that you can also shoot MPEG-4 movies at up to 640 x 480 pixels at 30 frames per second? No? Well, it can! Just so you know, this is DVD-quality video.

Ergonomically as well, the camera is well-designed and features an EX button to allow quick access to shooting controls. Once in the controls, you can also make the most of the post-shot white balance and exposure adjustments to make sure your photos are looking their best.

The Exilim Z750 is in competition with cameras such as Canon's SD500 and Sony's DSC-P200 in one of the most fiercely competitive segments of the market and offers by far the largest feature set in its class.

Priced at approximately Rs 19,000, this is one camera that offers great value for money and is perhaps the most stunning gift you could give anyone. Do you know our address?



Tech Shopping

NIKON COOLPIX 5900

The megapixel count of digital cameras is ever on the increase and today, a 4-megapixel camera is perhaps more the norm than an exception. Digicam prices have fallen beyond imagination, and a 4- or 5-mp camera is within reach for most.

One such camera that fits the bill for most casual users is the Nikon Coolpix 5900. A 5.1-megapixel camera, the 5900 has 3x optical zoom, 13.5 MB of internal memory—and the Nikon tag! What's better, all this is available for just Rs 14,000! Could you ask for more? Even if you did, there is!

The Coolpix 5900 combines state-of-the-art technology, great image quality and speed with an all-metal design, and is an eye-catcher. At the back of the camera is a big two-inch

LCD screen, the biggest yet in the Coolpix line-up, and the new Face-priority AF feature.

Also inbuilt is the D-Lighting feature that can be selected in Playback mode—automatically compensating for insufficient flash or excessive backlighting. It ensures balanced exposure throughout the frame.

The Coolpix 5900 can also shoot VGA movies with sound at a rate of 30 fps. Available across the country, the product retails at approximately Rs 14,000 and is great as a gift—for yourself or for your near and dear ones.

**SONY DCR HC 90E**

If you're looking for more than stills and are interested in venturing into the moving-image arena, here's one product you should consider: the Sony DCR HC 90E. With 10x optical and 120x digital zoom, this camera is farsighted!

Armed with a Carl Zeiss Vario-Sonnar T* lens, the clarity when you capture the 530 lines of horizontal resolution is simply stunning. The optics on this little baby are a treat and perhaps the best available.

Features-wise, too, the camera packs a punch. It has a 2.7-inch wide touch panel swivel screen that rotates up to 270 degrees to provide multiple viewing angles. The truly 'steady shot picture stabilisation system' stabilises without compromising on picture quality.

One great thing about this camera is the Analogue to Digital converter that lets you connect any analogue video source to digital using the provided inputs. But this is not just a camcorder—you can also shoot stills at a resolution of 2048 x 1512 (about 3 megapixels).

Another thoughtful addition that would be of great help to non-tech savvy users is the 'Easy Handycam' button. With a press of this button, most advanced features of the camera are 'locked out', leaving operational only the buttons essential for recording.

Priced at about Rs 51,500, this is one great deal.

